

Ankit Raj

Senior Technical Engineer - GISC

Stockholm, Sweden | ankit.raj@hm.com | github.com/ankit-raj_hmgroup

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Platform engineering leader with 10+ years building, automating, and operating hosting platforms at scale across hybrid environments - Azure, Google Cloud, and on-premises datacenters. I turn architectural vision into working services: cloud-native and containerised platforms, infrastructure-as-code, and self-service developer experiences that let 200+ product teams ship faster. Hands-on across Kubernetes, Terraform, Ansible, and CI/CD, with a strong track record driving legacy-to-cloud-native transitions, FinOps-led cost optimisation (35% reduction), and secure-by-design platforms aligned to PCI-DSS, GDPR, and ISO 27001. I pair strong execution with stakeholder engagement, partnering with architects, product owners, security, and FinOps to align hosting capabilities with business, digital, and sustainability goals.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Platform Engineering	Internal Developer Platforms, Self-Service Provisioning, Golden-Path Stacks, Reusable Reference Patterns, Developer Experience
Hybrid Hosting	Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud, On-Premises Datacenters, Virtualisation, Hybrid Connectivity, Legacy-to-Cloud-Native Migration
Containers & Orchestration	Kubernetes (AKS, GKE, OpenShift), Docker, Helm, Service Mesh, Auto-Scaling
laC & Automation	Terraform, Ansible, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, CI/CD Pipelines, GitOps
FinOps & Optimisation	Cost Optimisation, Right-Sizing, Demand Forecasting, Reserved Capacity, Cloud Spend Governance
Security & Compliance	Secure-by-Design, PCI-DSS, GDPR, ISO 27001, Zero Trust, RBAC, Policy-as-Code
Data & Analytics	Microsoft Fabric, BigQuery, Real-Time Analytics, Platform Observability (ELK, Grafana, Prometheus)
Leadership & Advisory	Technical Roadmaps, Strategic Planning & Execution, Stakeholder Engagement, Governance Frameworks, Mentoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Technical Engineer - GISC 2025 - Present

H&M Group, Stockholm

- Drive technical execution of the enterprise hosting strategy across Azure, Google Cloud, and on-premises datacenters - translating long-term business, digital, and sustainability goals into an actionable technical roadmap for 200+ product teams
- Led cloud observability for the Mozart, Google Cloud, and Azure platforms on Microsoft Fabric - unified telemetry, dashboards, and alerting across the hybrid estate
- Built an AI-powered coding platform for focus groups - accelerating team transition to managed services and improving developer productivity
- Led a SonarQube proof-of-concept - establishing code quality gates, static analysis, and security scanning integrated into CI/CD pipelines across teams
- Led a GenAI proof-of-concept for engineering productivity - evaluating LLM-assisted workflows for code, documentation, and operational tasks
- Established enterprise governance frameworks - policies, security baselines, RBAC, and compliance controls across 1600+ subscriptions, partnering with cybersecurity teams on secure-by-design hosting
- Built enterprise data and analytics foundations on Microsoft Fabric - governed, self-service access enabling analytics and reporting across business units
- Mentored and upskilled 8+ engineers and architects on platform design, laC, and operational excellence - helping new PMs and engineers understand the product lifecycle and promoting a culture of continuous improvement

Senior Platform Engineer - Azure Engineering 2022 - 2025

H&M Group, Stockholm

- Engineered the platform backbone on Azure - achieving 99.9% uptime SLA for 200+ product teams across global operations
- Led a multi-million SEK FinOps programme with the FinOps team - right-sizing, reserved capacity, demand forecasting, and automated governance reducing cloud spend by 35%
- Designed and built an Internal Developer Platform with self-service provisioning (EventGrid + Functions) - reducing team onboarding from days to minutes and accelerating product delivery
- Automated infrastructure and platform operations with Terraform and CI/CD, embedding DevOps practices and self-service golden paths across teams
- Conducted deep-dive architecture reviews and design exercises, creating reusable patterns and best-practice guidance for cross-team adoption

Senior Software Engineer - Integrations Platform 2020 - 2022

H&M Group, Stockholm

- Led HAPI integration platform infrastructure development on Azure API Management - handling 2 billion+ requests during peak sales with high availability and auto-scaling
- Led the transition from legacy infrastructure to cloud-native, containerised platforms - standardising Kubernetes (AKS, GKE), Terraform laC, and DevOps automation to enable self-service and agility
- Designed Zero Trust microservices architecture - 15+ services with sub-100ms p99 latency, demonstrating deep infrastructure and networking expertise
- Built high-throughput GraphQL & REST APIs handling 50K+ RPM on Azure + GKE with automated scaling and rate limiting
- Led CI/CD standardisation using GitHub Actions across 200+ repositories - 95% pipeline success rate, establishing DevOps best practices at enterprise scale
- Resolved complex reliability issues through root-cause analysis across distributed systems, improving platform stability and developer experience

Cloud Architect - AML/KYC Modernisation 2020

Cognizant Technology Solutions - Ikano Bank, Stockholm

- Architected and delivered proof-of-concept migration of AML & KYC APIs from an on-premises datacenter (Axway API gateway) to AWS serverless - reducing latency by 70%
- Designed the hybrid migration path from on-prem infrastructure to event-driven cloud services (Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB) processing 500K+ daily financial transactions with Terraform laC
- Managed on-prem to cloud connectivity, identity migration (Curity to AWS Cognito, OAuth 2.0/OIDC), and multi-account governance with AWS Organisations and CloudWatch observability
- Built CI/CD with GitHub Actions and Terraform replacing legacy manual datacenter deployments - deployment frequency increased 10x with automated quality gates
- Authored migration playbooks and ADRs enabling the bank's internal teams to continue the modernisation programme independently

DevOps Lead - Automotive

2019 - 2020

Volvo Cars, Gothenburg

- Led DevOps and platform delivery for engineering teams - designing and operating an enterprise observability platform (ELK, Grafana, Prometheus) on AKS monitoring 100+ automotive microservices
- Operated hybrid infrastructure across on-premises datacenters and cloud - managing CI/CD pipelines for on-prem OpenShift & Kubernetes clusters and reducing deployment cycle time from hours to 15 minutes
- Managed datacenter capacity, virtualisation, and cluster lifecycle for production automotive workloads - authoring runbooks and incident response achieving 99.5% SLA compliance
- Partnered with cross-functional teams to resolve infrastructure bottlenecks, translating automotive requirements into optimised hybrid hosting solutions

Cloud DevOps Engineer to Cloud Developer

2016 - 2019

Cognizant Technology Solutions

- Designed and implemented AWS cloud architectures for 5+ enterprise clients - CI/CD pipelines with CodePipeline, Docker, ECS/Fargate across diverse verticals
- Automated server configuration and application deployments with Ansible playbooks - standardising provisioning across on-prem and cloud environments and reducing manual configuration effort
- Automated resource tagging and policy governance across AWS and Azure using AWS Config Rules, Azure Policy, and Lambda - ensuring compliance and cost attribution
- Won 1st place at Enterprise AWS Game Day 2018 (200+ participants) and led knowledge transfer building cloud fluency across client teams

CERTIFICATIONS

- **AWS Certified DevOps Engineer - Professional**
- **AWS Certified Developer - Associate**
- **Google Cloud Certified - Associate Cloud Engineer**
- **Microsoft Certified Professional (MCP) - Exam 533: Azure Infrastructure**
- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)**
- Microsoft OpenHack: AI-Powered Knowledge Mining · Containers · Security, Compliance & Identity · DevOps
- Google India Udacity Scholar

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology - Computer Science & Engineering

2012 - 2016

Galgotias University, Greater Noida, India

Specialisation in Cloud Computing & Virtualisation.